



University of
St Andrews

Teaching Staff Participant Information Sheet

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USER-CENTRED DESIGN OF GAMES FOR GAELIC DIGITAL NORMALISATION

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What is the study about?

You are invited to participate in a research project examining how digital games can be designed and used to support Gaelic language learning and usage within Gaelic Medium Education (GME) contexts. The research aims to create an age-appropriate and culturally sensitive game prototype that encourages learners to use Gaelic actively while engaging in interactive activities. The study will investigate how game-based interaction may aid in the digital normalisation of Gaelic, making it a more prevalent and natural part of daily life for young speakers.

Why have I been invited to take part?

You have been invited because you are a GME teacher with professional expertise, classroom experience, and a critical role in ensuring that all research activities are appropriate for your pupils and in line with school policies. Your participation helps ensure that educational and safeguarding standards are met, and your consent confirms the suitability of pupils, along with their parents' consent, who may be involved in classroom-based user testing and evaluation.

Do I have to take part?

This information sheet has been written to help you decide if you would like to take part. It is up to you and you alone whether you wish to take part. If you do decide to take part, you will be free to withdraw at any time without providing a reason and with no negative consequences.

What would I be required to do?

If you agree to participate, you will be asked to:

- Participate in a brief mock game session (approximately 30 minutes) before the main research day, during which you will review the game prototype, confirm its age-appropriateness and cultural suitability, verify alignment with school safeguarding policies, and provide initial feedback.
- Share your professional insights on cultural sensitivity, age appropriateness, and classroom integration.
- Help facilitate classroom user testing sessions (approximately 60 minutes) and provide feedback on pupils' engagement and learning outcomes.
- Take part in a post-session questionnaire to advise on the design, content, and suitability of the Gaelic language game prototype
- Review and comment on project resources and participate in any follow-up discussions as needed.

Are there any risks associated with taking part?

Risks are minimal, but may include:

- Minor inconvenience (time commitment for interviews, review sessions, and technical issues).
- Potential emotional discomfort for children if they encounter challenges playing the game.
- Data privacy concerns, especially in handling classroom or pupil information.

Steps to minimise risks:

- The session will be scheduled at your convenience and will remain confidential.
- All personal and sensitive data will be anonymised or pseudonymised, securely stored, and handled in full compliance with University and UK data protection laws.
- Support resources and contact information for follow-up queries or concerns will be provided.

Are there any benefits associated with taking part?

Your participation will play a vital role in developing better digital resources for Gaelic language education, potentially benefiting future teachers and learners. The research may lead to new insights and improved tools for supporting Gaelic Medium pupils in a digital environment.

Informed consent

It is important that you can give your informed consent before taking part in this study. You will have the opportunity to ask questions about the research before you provide your consent.

Reward/compensation

No direct financial reward is offered for teaching staff. Please note that, as a token of appreciation, participating children will receive a certificate and a small stationery item.

What information about me or recordings of me ('my data') will you be collecting?

Data collected will include:

- Professional feedback on the game prototype and study activities through the provided questionnaire.
- Any additional written comments or communications you provide.

Terms used to describe your data

- **Pseudonymised:** Your data will be assigned a participant code (e.g., "T01") instead of your name, with a secure key linking the code to your identity (retained only by the research team). Once this key is deleted, your data becomes anonymised.
- **Anonymised:** Data edited or deleted such that no one, including researchers, can identify you.

How will my data be stored and who will have access to it?

- Data will be initially stored in **pseudonymised** form on secure University cloud servers. Only the researcher and supervisor will have access to the data.
- The key linking your code to your identity will be stored in a separate secure location, accessible only to the researcher. 48 hours after data collection is complete, this key will be deleted, meaning your data will be fully **anonymised**.

How will my data be used and in what form will it be shared further?

- Your data will be analysed for this research study, and **only anonymised data** may be included in the researcher's dissertation, academic publications, or presentations.
- Your data may be made publicly available in anonymised form by placing it in a data repository for the purpose of further research. All users, including the public, will have access.
- It is expected that the project to which this research relates will be finalised by April 2026

When will my data be destroyed?

All pseudonymised data will be destroyed safely 48 hours after data collection; thereafter, anonymised data will be retained for the duration of the project.

Will my participation be confidential?

Your participation as a teacher will be confidential to the research team and ethics committee. However, please note that because this research involves a group classroom session, other school staff, parents, and pupils in your school may be aware of your involvement in supervising the research activity. When research findings are published or shared, all data will be pseudonymised then anonymised to protect your identity. You will not be identifiable from any published materials.

Use of your personal data for research and your data protection rights

The University of St Andrews (the 'Data Controller') is bound by the UK 2018 Data Protection Act and the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), which require a lawful basis for all processing of personal data (in this case it is the 'performance of a task carried out in the public interest' – namely, for research purposes) and an additional lawful basis for processing personal data containing special characteristics (in this case it is 'public interest research'). You have a range of rights under data protection legislation. For more information on data protection legislation and your rights visit <https://www.st-andrews.ac.uk/terms/data-protection/rights/>. For any queries, email dataprot@st-andrews.ac.uk.

Withdrawing your data

You can withdraw your data **up to 48 hours after the data is collected**. When your data is anonymised, we will not be able to withdraw it, because we will not know which data is yours. Should you want to have your data removed, please e-mail the researcher or supervisor as soon as possible within this period.

Ethics review

This research proposal has been scrutinised and subsequently granted ethical approval by the University of St Andrews Teaching and Research Ethics Committee. **[APPROVAL NUMBER TO BE INSERTED]**

Where can I find out about the results of the study?

Results will be shared via a summary email and letter. If feasible, and on an open-access resource, which will be shared with you.

What should I do if I have concerns about this study?

In the first instance, you are encouraged to raise your concerns with the researcher. However, if you do not feel comfortable doing so, then you should contact the supervisor or the School Ethics Contact (contact details below). A full outline of the procedures governed by the University Teaching and Research Ethics Committee is available at:

Contact details:

Researcher: Luke Macleod University email address: lcm31@st-andrews.ac.uk	Supervisor: Dr Abd Alsattar Ardati University email address: abd.ardati@st-andrews.ac.uk University telephone number: +44 (0)1334 46 1861	School ethics contact: Dr Olexandr Konovalov University email address: obk1@st-andrews.ac.uk University telephone number: +44 (0)1334 46 1633
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